

Cabinets

If the word cabinet didn't ring a bell then quite a lot of people refer to it as the "CPU" and they couldn't be more wrong. We are talking about the big hunk of metal in which all the essential components of the computer are mounted. From the motherboard to the power supply and every other thing except the display, keyboard and the mouse.



Form factors

While motherboards are categorised as ATX, ITX and mATX, the cabinets are built around these dimensions, so they come as:

1. Mini-ITX
2. Mini-Tower
3. Mid-Tower
4. Full-Tower

The bigger ones generally support all smaller sizes, you just have to mount the screws in the right holes, however, it would be a bit ridiculous getting a colossal cabinet for a mini-ITX motherboard unless of course you plan on stuffing a lot of hard drives in there. The full-tower has a lot of space and can support a host of peripherals that you may deem necessary for your configuration. The mid-tower is the most common size available owing to its familiarity and price. The mini-tower and the mini-ITX are sort of the most difficult to put together unless they come pre-assembled. You need to follow a particular sequence in order to fit stuff in it and even then you are unlikely to be able to have the big graphics cards that are all too common nowadays. The sequence stays true for almost any assembly but you can mix it up a bit when dealing with a mid-tower and a full-tower.

